

NVA OFFICER (1917–2002)

GENERAL VAN TIEN DUNG

Dung joined the Indochinese Communist Party in the 1930s and was imprisoned by the French colonialists for subversion. From 1945, he served as a general in the Viet Minh guerrilla movement and then as chief of staff of the North Vietnamese Army.

In 1974, he replaced General Vo Nguyen Giap as commander of the NVA and led the final offensive in South Vietnam. He went on to command the NVA in wars with Cambodia and China in 1979 before retiring in 1986.



» AFTER

Responding to the sudden collapse of South Vietnamese resistance, the North Vietnamese leadership set General Dung a new target—to capture Saigon before the onset of the monsoon season in May.

FROM XUAN LOC TO SAIGON

The advance of North Vietnamese forces was **temporarily stalled** by determined resistance by the ARVN at **Xuan Loc**. In a fierce two-week battle, South Vietnamese troops acquitted themselves with credit, but the town eventually fell.

President Thieu **accepted the inevitability of defeat** and resigned on April 21. The remaining units of the ARVN were in disarray, and North Vietnamese forces rapidly advanced toward the largely undefended **Saigon**.